Editable pack for the bus boycott

Friday 22 January 2027 | P2 | 40 minutes | Year A

Humanities | GROW | Spring 1 Week 3 | HUM-GROW-S1-W03

Learning outcome: Explain causes and consequences of a protest movement.

Enquiry: Why did the boycott happen, and what followed?

In Montgomery, Alabama, USA, racist bus rules kept Black and White riders apart. Black residents and local groups had challenged unfair treatment for years. Rosa Parks was arrested on 1 December 1955. The boycott began on 5 December. Protest, shared work and a legal case all mattered.

You may point, write, type, speak privately or direct a scribe. Reading aloud and public answers are optional. You may pass.

Today I can

I can sort causes, the trigger and consequences.

I can make my own diagram with clear links.

I can explain reasons and results in a short paragraph.

Our shared sort

Cause Finder places a card. Link Checker asks why it fits. Swap and rotate. Sort A–H into four groups; use P1 beside the change in law.

Your own work

In your book, complete your own diagram: two long-term causes, the trigger, two short-term consequences (including B) and one long-term consequence. Keep card codes. Add the legal case beside the change in bus law. Write a short paragraph that explains a cause and two consequences with clear links. State one limit to the change.

Choose one route. The sort cards, diagram layout and paragraph support follow. Print only the pages needed.

Use the quiet signal to ask the adult for a pause. Use the agreed supervised place. No public reason is needed. Return with one small card check or a private recap when ready.

Your cause and consequence task

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Route Supported

Learning outcome: Explain causes and consequences of a protest movement.

1 Use all eight cards with an adult reading exactly if helpful. Sort one category at a time with the category mat. Explain at least one choice.

2 Copy the diagram into your book or use ready-cut labels. Keep two causes, the trigger, two short-term effects and one longer-term effect. Add P1 beside the law change.

3 Write, type or direct a scribe for your own paragraph. Use the frame and connectives bank. Keep a reason, two effects and the limit that racism did not end.

Your own finish

In your book, complete your own diagram: two long-term causes, the trigger, two short-term consequences (including B) and one long-term consequence. Keep card codes. Add the legal case beside the change in bus law. Write a short paragraph that explains a cause and two consequences with clear links. State one limit to the change.

Paragraph frame

One long-term cause was ____ (card __). This mattered because ____. The trigger was ____ on ____. In the short term, ____ because ____. The legal case also ____. Later, ____. However, ____.

Plan in any language. Use your book, typing or exact scribing. Record the help used.

Your cause and consequence task

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Route Independent

Learning outcome: Explain causes and consequences of a protest movement.

1 Sort A–H into the four groups. Use dates and reasons, then check the process note P1.

2 Complete your own diagram in your book, using the common finish and card codes. Label arrows with how one thing affected another.

3 Write a short explanation paragraph with because, as a result and however. Link the legal case to the law change and keep a clear limit.

Your own finish

In your book, complete your own diagram: two long-term causes, the trigger, two short-term consequences (including B) and one long-term consequence. Keep card codes. Add the legal case beside the change in bus law. Write a short paragraph that explains a cause and two consequences with clear links. State one limit to the change.

Paragraph frame

One long-term cause was ____ (card __). This mattered because ____. The trigger was ____ on ____. In the short term, ____ because ____. The legal case also ____. Later, ____. However, ____.

Plan in any language. Use your book, typing or exact scribing. Record the help used.

Your cause and consequence task

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Route Aspire

Learning outcome: Explain causes and consequences of a protest movement.

1 Keep the same sort, diagram and paragraph. Defend a choice where a card can play more than one part, such as travel and support (E).

2 Explain how an effect during the boycott could also help sustain it. Distinguish a reason for protest from a means of organising it.

3 Weigh the roles of protest and legal action. Explain one longer-term influence without claiming it caused every later civil-rights change.

Your own finish

In your book, complete your own diagram: two long-term causes, the trigger, two short-term consequences (including B) and one long-term consequence. Keep card codes. Add the legal case beside the change in bus law. Write a short paragraph that explains a cause and two consequences with clear links. State one limit to the change.

Paragraph frame

One long-term cause was ____ (card __). This mattered because ____. The trigger was ____ on ____. In the short term, ____ because ____. The legal case also ____. Later, ____. However, ____.

Plan in any language. Use your book, typing or exact scribing. Record the help used.

Cause and consequence sort cards

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These cards are new factual teaching summaries, written in 2026. No old text, speech, testimony or picture is copied. A–H are the sort set. P1 is a process note to use beside the sort.

E New ways to travel

During the boycott, 1955–1956

Many people walked or shared car rides instead of using buses. Volunteers arranged lifts and raised funds. Staying off buses changed daily travel. Shared help also made it easier to keep the protest going.

Research basis: H1, H3, H5.

A An arrest

1 December 1955

Rosa Parks was arrested after refusing to give up her bus seat. Organisers called for people to stay off buses on 5 December. This event helped set off the boycott.

Research basis: H1.

G A model for later protests

After the boycott, in later years

The boycott showed how people could keep a joint protest going without using violence. Later rights campaigns could draw on that example. It was one influence among many.

Research basis: H1, H3.

Cause and consequence sort cards

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C Unfair bus rules

Before December 1955

Black passengers faced racist seating rules and unfair treatment on Montgomery buses. These problems had lasted for years. They gave people reasons to seek change.

Research basis: H1, H2.

H Fewer bus fares

During the boycott, 1955–1956

When many passengers stopped using buses, the bus company took in less fare money. This put pressure on the company. It did not, by itself, change the law.

Research basis: H5.

D Links that lasted

After the boycott, in later years

The campaign built links among people and groups working for civil rights. Those links helped support joint work beyond Montgomery in the years that followed.

Research basis: H3.

Cause and consequence sort cards

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Humanities | GROW | Spring 1 Week 3 | HUM-GROW-S1-W03

F Earlier calls for change

1954, before the boycott

The Women's Political Council asked for fairer bus treatment before 1955. It made requests in 1954. Little changed. These problems gave people a reason to seek stronger action.

Research basis: H1, H2.

B A change to bus seating

20–21 December 1956

After the court order reached Montgomery, the boycott ended on 20 December. People returned to buses on 21 December with the old seating rule removed. The legal case helped secure this change.

Research basis: H1, H4.

P1 A legal case alongside the protest

5 June and 13 November 1956

Four Black women continued the court case Browder v. Gayle. Federal judges ruled against bus segregation on 5 June. The US Supreme Court upheld the ruling on 13 November. The order reached Montgomery in December.

P1 is not a ninth sort card. Link this legal process to card B. Refusing bus travel did not itself overturn the law.

Research basis: H4.

Your cause and consequence diagram

Friday 22 January 2027 | P2 | 40 minutes | Year A

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Learning outcome: Explain causes and consequences of a protest movement.

Copy this layout in your book. Complete the boxes with card codes and your own short notes. Use two causes, one trigger, two short-term effects (including B) and one long-term effect.

Long-term causes Cause 1 ____ (__) Cause 2 ____ (__)		Trigger Event and date ____ (__)
↘ reasons for change		helped set off action ↙
Montgomery bus boycott Begins 5 December 1955		
↙ short-term effects		long-term effects ↘
Short-term consequences 1 ____ (B) 2 ____ (__)		Long-term consequence One effect in later years ____ (__)

Label arrows with a reason. Add a separate legal-case note (P1) beside the law-change result and link it with an arrow. Several factors worked together.

The arrows organise your explanation. An arrow alone is not proof of a link. Say how one thing helped lead to another.

You may point, write, type, speak privately or direct a scribe. Reading aloud and public answers are optional. You may pass.

Your explanation paragraph

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Why did the boycott happen, and what followed?

Use your diagram to explain a cause and two consequences. Include one short-term and one long-term effect. Explain how each is linked to the campaign. Use card codes. Add the legal case and one limit.

A frame you may use

One long-term cause was ____ (card __). This mattered because ____. The trigger was ____ on ____. In the short term, ____ because ____. The legal case also ____. Later, ____. However, ____.

Connectives bank

Word or phrase	How it helps
because	gives a reason
so	links a reason to a result
as a result	introduces a consequence
also	adds another factor
later	marks time, not proof of a cause
however	adds a limit or a different point

Check before you finish

Have you explained why, not just what came next? Is the trigger different from the long-term causes? Is P1 linked to the change in bus law? Have you said that changed bus rights did not end racism?

You may use ready-cut labels and direct a scribe. Keep your own explanations, not just the group's sort.

Use the quiet signal to ask the adult for a pause. Use the agreed supervised place. No public reason is needed. Return with one small card check or a private recap when ready.